Zach Lang

Department of History and Political Science
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Academic Positions

2024-present: Assistant Professor of Political Science, Department of History and Political Science, Anderson University

Education

2019-2024: Ph.D., Truman School of Government and Public Affairs- University of Missouri
Ph.D. Fellow: Kinder Institute on Constitutional Democracy
Concentrations: American Politics, Public Policy
Advisor: Peverill Squire

2015-2019: B.A., St. Lawrence University
Magna Cum Laude
Major: Government
Minor: History

Teaching & Research Interests

The Constitution, Federalism, Judicial Process & Politics, American Political Thought (1755-1825)

Teaching Experience

Anderson University- Assistant Professor

PS 101- *American National Government*- Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026

PS 102- *State and Local Government*- Fall 2025

PS 301- *Public Policy*- Spring 2025

PS 303- *American Political Institutions*- Fall 2024

PS 310- *Judicial Process*- Spring 2025

PS 399- *Political Thought*- Spring 2026

PS/HIS 399- *The Constitutional Debates*- Spring 2026

PS 410- *Civil Rights & Civil Liberties*- Fall 2025

PS 435- *Campaigns and Elections*- Fall 2024

CON 399- *The Politics of Star Wars*- Spring 2025, Spring 2026

University of Missouri- Graduate Instructor

PS 2004: *The Politics of Star Wars*- Fall 2023, Spring 2024

PS 1100: *American Government*- Fall 2022

University of Missouri- Lead Graduate Assistant for American Government Game-Based Learning Grant (2022-2024)

Worked under Dr. Tori Mondelli to create an American government video game and in-person tabletop games. Led TA implementation and student playtesting. Lead designer of Supreme Court Nomination and Bureaucratic Politics Games and political typology test.

Other

- PhD Dissertation Writing Coach. Anderson University Graduate School (Summer 2025)
- Missouri Scholars Academy: Political Science Educational Game Instructor (Summer 2024)
- Teaching and Professional Development Program, University of Missouri (Spring 2023)
- Substitute Teacher: European History, Hereford High School, MD (Spring 2017)
- Creator, Head Coach: Hereford Zone Running Camp (Summer 2016-2021)

Invited Speaker

- "Professor Lore Night" speaker, Anderson University (Spring 2026)
- "Careers in History and Political Science" panelist, Anderson University (Fall 2025)
- "Should There be Page Limits? Comparing National Constitutions on Constitution Day" Constitution Day speaker, Anderson University (Fall 2025)
- "Faith and Learning Dialogue: Engaging Students on Controversial Topics" panelist at Faculty In-Service, Anderson University (Fall 2025)
- "Voting and the 2024 Presidential Election" panelist at campus-wide event, Anderson University (Fall 2024)

- "The International Relations of Game of Thrones" GOVT 371, St. Lawrence University. (Spring 2021, Fall 2021, Spring 2022, Spring 2025)

Academic Publications

Articles

1. "State Politics in the Early Republic and the Development of the American Executive: Representation, Party Politics, and Executive Selection Mechanisms 1788-1832." With Aric Gooch (R&R at the *Journal of the Early Republic*).
2. "Unlimited Power: Energy Policy, State Politics, and Multistate Litigation Against the Federal Government." Invited for special issue: 2025 Annual Review of Federalism in *Publius: The Journal of Federalism* (2025). Available at: https://academic.oup.com/publius/article-abstract/55/3/445/8211976?redirectedFrom=fulltext
3. "Lessons from Dragons: Teaching Political Science with HBO's House of the Dragon." With Ronnie Olesker. *Journal of Political Science Education.* (2024). Available at: https://www.tandfonline.com/doi/full/10.1080/15512169.2024.2330931?src=exp-la

Book Chapters

1. How Liberty Dies: The Politics of the Prequel Era in *Politics and the Empire* (Forthcoming in print September 2026) edited by James Endersby and Steven Galatas. Bloomsbury Publishing.
2. Rebel Scum? Resistance, Rebellion, and Civil War in the Star Wars Universe *in Politics and the Empire* (Forthcoming in print September 2026) edited by James Endersby and Steven Galatas. Bloomsbury Publishing.
3. Red Tape: A Bureaucratic Politics Game in *Beating the Clock: The Power of Short Games and Active Learning in the Political Science Classroom* (2026) edited by Mark Harvey, James Fielder, Ryan Gibb, and Derek Glasgow. Taylor and Francis: Routledge Press.
4. GalactiVote: Government in Action! An American Government Video Game with Hillary Gould and Tori Mondelli. in *Lecture Notes in Computer Science* (2025) edited by J.L. Plass and X. Ochea: Springer Nature Switzerland. Originally accepted for the Joint International Conference on Serious Games: New York University (2024).

Media Appearances

- Featured in Anderson University's *Synthesis Magazine*: "From Push Pins to Bobbleheads: Office Décor Shows of Professors' Personalities" by Ella Lundgren.

Summer 2025 issue. Available here: https://andersonuniversity.edu/academics/arts-and-sciences/synthesis-magazine/

- Featured in Anderson University's *Synthesis Magazine*: "Star Wars in the Classroom: Students Examine Politics of a Galaxy Far, Far Away" by Sam Quiambao. Summer 2025 issue. Available here: https://andersonuniversity.edu/academics/arts-and-sciences/synthesis-magazine/
- *CS Lewis is Smarter Than You* Podcast: ""Delinquents in the Snow," "Dangers of National Repentance," and "Mediations on the Third Commandment"" Spring 2025. Available on Apple Podcasts: https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/delinquents-in-the-snow-dangers-of-national/id1794462226?i=1000696624529
- *KOPN Radio*: "Politics and Philosophy." Fall 2021

Conference Presentations

Chair/Moderator:

- May 2024. Moderator for sessions: "Customizing Chat GPT to create a GPT Teaching Assistant" and "Bringing Your Classroom to Life! How to Utilize Live Demonstrations to Enhance Understanding of Complex Concepts." Celebration of Teaching Conference. University of Missouri.
- April 2021. Panel chair for: "The Aftermath of the 2020 Election." Southwestern Political Science Association. New Orleans, Louisiana (virtual).

Panelist:

- April 2026. "The Dragon in our Minds: Exposure Impact to Game of Thrones and House of the Dragon on Student's Political Attitudes. Pop Culture Association Conference. Atlanta, GA.
- January 2026. "How Liberty Dies: The Politics of the Prequel Era" Southern Political Science Association Conference. New Orleans, LA.
- March 2025. "The Dragon in Our Minds: the impact of exposure to Game of Thrones and House of the Dragon fictional narratives on students' political attitudes" International Studies Association Conference. Chicago, IL.
- January 2024. "Red Tape: Bureaucracy in Action" board game presentation at CUNY Adult Learning Games Conference. New York, New York (virtual).
- April 2023. "The States Strike Back: The Role of Attorneys General in Multistate Litigation Against the Federal Government." Selected for Graduate Student Workshop, Shawnee Trail Regional Conference on American Politics and Constitutionalism. Columbia, MO.
- April 2023. "The States Strike Back: The Role of Attorneys General in Multistate Litigation Against the Federal Government." Midwest Political Science Association. Chicago, Illinois.
- March 2023. "Lessons from Dragons: Teaching Political Science Through House of the Dragon." International Studies Association. Montreal, Quebec.

- April 2021. "The Elitist Few or the Populist Many? Public Demand, Representation, and Health-Interest Groups in the American States." Southwestern Political Science Association. New Orleans, Louisiana (virtual).
- June 2019. "Chaos is a ladder: A study of identity, norms, and power transition in the Game of Thrones universe." British International Studies Association. London, England.
- November 2018. "Chaos is a ladder: A study of identity, norms, and power transition in the Game of Thrones universe." Northeastern Political Science Association. Montreal, Quebec.

Service

Anderson University

Current

- Athletics Oversight Committee Member (Fall 2024-present)
- Political Science Advisor (Spring 2025-present)
- Faculty Mentor, Men's/Women's Cross Country (Fall 2025-present)
- Faculty Mentor, Men's/Women's Track & Field (Spring 2025-present)
- Leadership Team, Athletics Mentor Program (Spring 2025-present)
- Pre-Law Advisor (LSAC Certified) (Fall 2025-present)
- Secondary Social Studies Advisor (Fall 2025-present)
- Pi Sigma Alpha Faculty Advisor (Fall 2025-present)
- Liberty-Cap Society Advisor (Fall 2025-present)

Past

- Founder of the Athletics Mentor Program (Spring 2025)
- Phi Alpha Theta Advisor (Fall 2025-Spring 2026)
- History Advisor (Fall 2025)

University of Missouri

- Graduate Student Mentor: Joe Harrison, Antony Jackson (Spring 2021-Spring 2023)
- Secretary, Graduate Association of Political Scientists (Fall 2022-Spring 2022)
- Kinder Institute First Year Interest Group and Residential College Fellow (Fall 2022)
- Kinder Institute DC Summer Scholars Program Acceptance Committee Member (Fall 2022)

Discipline

- W.W. Norton & Company Inc: Reviewer; Civics Foundational Documents: Readings and Support

Awards

Anderson University

- *Recognized Faculty Member of the home Football Game*, for service to Athletics (2024)

University of Missouri

- *Graduate Fellowship*. Kinder Institute on Constitutional Democracy (2019-2024)

St. Lawrence University

- *Outstanding Student Athlete Award* (2019)
- *Summer Research Fellowship* (2018)
- *Chi Sigma Alpha member* (2015-2019)
- *Chi Alpha Sigma member* (2015-2019)
- NCAA Division III *Liberty League All-Academic Team*: Cross Country and Track & Field (2015-2019)
- *Sesquicentennial Scholarship* (2015-2019)
- *Presidential Scholarship* (2015-2019)

Boy Scouts of America

- *Eagle Scout, Silver Palm, Order of the Arrow* (2013)

Professional Memberships

- Southern Political Science Association
- International Studies Association
- Pop Culture Association

References

Dr. Peverill Squire- University of Missouri (retired)
Hicks and Martha Griffith Chair in American Political Institutions
squirep@missouri.edu

Dr. Ronnie Olesker- St. Lawrence University
Michael and Virginia Ranger Professor of Political Science
Associate Dean for Faculty Affairs
rolesker@stlawu.edu

Dr. Jay Dow- University of Missouri
Professor
Dow@missouri.edu